APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — INDIAN POLITY

Volume 1: The Constitution — making, features, Preamble, rights and amendments, explained from the basics

Road to the Constitution · Sources and features · Preamble · Union and citizenship · Fundamental Rights and writs · Directive Principles and Duties · Amendments and basic structure · Landmark cases · Master list of articles, parts, schedules

How to use this volume:
1. Colours: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Andhra Pradesh / Telangana link · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-test · **Yellow** = LATEST (2024–26; verify before the exam).
2. Polity is a LINK subject: every article connects to a case, a committee or a current event. The 'Links' boxes show those connections. Learn the article number WITH its one-line meaning.
3. Syllabus: Group 1 Prelims Paper I Part B items 1 (Constitution: evolution, features, Preamble, FR, FD, DPSP, amendments, basic structure); Mains Paper III (A) 1, 5; Group 2 Paper I Section B items 6. Volumes 2–5 cover the rest of Polity.
4. Plan: 9 chapters in 9 days; revise green boxes on day 3 and day 10; then Polity Mock Test 1.

Syllabus map

Syllabus item	Chapter
Evolution of the Constitution, Constituent Assembly, Ambedkar's role	1
Salient features, sources, nature (federal / unitary), Preamble	2, 3
Union and its territory, States reorganisation, citizenship	4
Fundamental Rights, writs, important cases	5, 6
DPSP, Fundamental Duties, FR–DPSP relation	7
Amendments, basic structure, landmark cases, key amendment acts	8
Master list of articles, parts and schedules	9

CHAPTER 1 — Making of the Constitution

1773 – 1950

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Why a Constitution? A country needs a rule-book that says who holds power, how far that power goes, and what rights every citizen has. India did not write it from scratch: the British Acts slowly gave Indians a share in governing, and the freedom movement then demanded that **Indians themselves** write their own rules.
Remember the idea: British Acts (1773–1935) = steps that gave us institutions (Governor-General, councils, federation). The Constituent Assembly (1946–49) = the step that gave us **sovereignty**.

Road to the Constitution

1773–1858	Regulating Act 1773 → Pitt's India Act 1784 → Charter Acts 1833, 1853 → GoI Act 1858 (Crown rule)
1861–1919	Councils Acts 1861, 1892 · Morley–Minto 1909 (separate electorates) · Montagu–Chelmsford 1919 (dyarchy in provinces)
1935	Government of India Act 1935: federation, provincial autonomy, Federal Court, RBI — about 70% of our Constitution is borrowed from it
1946–47	Cabinet Mission (May 1946) → Constituent Assembly elected (July 1946) → first meeting 9 Dec 1946 (Sachchidananda Sinha interim chair; Dr Rajendra Prasad President from 11 Dec)
1946–49	Objectives Resolution (Nehru, 13 Dec 1946; adopted 22 Jan 1947) · Drafting Committee set up 29 Aug 1947, chair Dr B.R. Ambedkar (7 members) · 2 years 11 months 18 days · 284 members signed 24 Jan 1950
1949–50	Adopted 26 Nov 1949 (Constitution Day) · in force 26 Jan 1950 (Republic Day; Purna Swaraj Day 1930) · Citizenship, elections, interim Parliament from 26 Nov 1949

Landmark Acts (what each gave)

Act	Key point
Regulating Act 1773	First step to regulate the East India Company; **Governor-General of Bengal** (Warren Hastings); **Supreme Court at Calcutta** (1774).
Pitt's India Act 1784	**Board of Control** (political) and Court of Directors (commercial): **dual control**.
Charter Act 1813, 1833, 1853	1813 ended trade monopoly (except tea, China); **1833: Governor-General of India** (William Bentinck), centralisation; **1853: open competition for civil service**, separate legislative council.
GoI Act 1858	After 1857: Company rule ended; **Secretary of State for India**, **Viceroy** (Lord Canning).
Indian Councils Acts 1861, 1892, 1909 (Morley–Minto)	1861: Indians nominated; portfolio system; 1892: indirect election; **1909: separate electorates for Muslims**.
GoI Act 1919 (Montagu–Chelmsford)	**Dyarchy** in provinces (Reserved and Transferred subjects); bicameral Centre; separate electorates for Sikhs etc.; **Public Service Commission** (1926).
GoI Act 1935	**All-India Federation** (never fully implemented), **provincial autonomy**, **Federal Court (1937)**, **RBI (1935)**, three lists (Federal, Provincial, Concurrent), **Governors' discretion**. Source of our administrative provisions.
Indian Independence Act 1947	Two dominions (India, Pakistan) from **15 Aug 1947**; Constituent Assembly became a **sovereign body and Parliament**; Viceroy post to Governor-General (Mountbatten).

The Constituent Assembly: who, how and what

Item	Facts
Idea	M.N. Roy (1934) proposed; INC demanded (1935); British accepted in **August Offer 1940**, **Cripps Mission 1942**, **Cabinet Mission 1946**.
Composition	Originally **389** (296 British India + 93 princely states); after Partition **299**. **Indirectly elected** by provincial assemblies, not by universal franchise. 15 women members (Sarojini Naidu, Hansa Mehta, Durgabai Deshmukh, Renuka Ray, Ammu Swaminathan...).
Key people	President: **Dr Rajendra Prasad**; Vice-President: H.C. Mukherjee and V.T. Krishnamachari; Constitutional Advisor: **B.N. Rau**; Drafting Committee chair: **B.R. Ambedkar**; Chief Draftsman: S.N. Mukerjee.
Drafting Committee (7)	B.R. Ambedkar (chair), **N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar, K.M. Munshi, Syed Mohammad Saadulla, N. Madhava Rao (replaced B.L. Mitter), D.P. Khaitan (died; replaced by T.T. Krishnamachari)**.
Other committees	Union Powers (Nehru), Union Constitution (Nehru), Provincial Constitution (**Patel**), **Fundamental Rights and Minorities (Patel)**, Rules of Procedure (Rajendra Prasad), Steering (K.M. Munshi), States (Nehru), Flag ad hoc (Rajendra Prasad).
Time	**2 years 11 months 18 days**; 11 sessions; 165 sitting days; 114 days on draft; ~**8,000** amendments proposed, ~2,500 moved.
Original text	**395 Articles, 22 Parts, 8 Schedules**. Today: ~**470** Articles in **25 Parts**, **12 Schedules** (after amendments).
Handwritten copies	Prem Behari Narain Raizada (italic calligraphy, English); Hindi by **Vasant Krishan Vaidya**; decorated by **Nandalal Bose** and Santiniketan artists; signed 24 Jan 1950; **Helium chamber, Parliament Library**.

ANDHRA PRADESH LINK

Andhra / Telangana links in the making: Pattabhi Sitaramayya (Machilipatnam, Coastal Andhra; INC president 1948) was a Constituent Assembly member; **Tanguturi Prakasam, Durgabai Deshmukh (Rajahmundry), N.G. Ranga (Guntur), Kala Venkata Rao (Vijayawada), Ayyadevara Kaleswara Rao** represented Andhra; **Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar** (Drafting Committee) and **Kala Venkata Rao** from the Madras Presidency; **Telangana** (Hyderabad State) was not yet in the Union when the Assembly began: it joined India after the **Police Action (Operation Polo), Sept 1948**.

EXAM TRAPS

Drafting Committee chairman = Ambedkar; Constituent Assembly president = Rajendra Prasad; Constitutional Advisor = B.N. Rau. The assembly was **not** elected by universal franchise.
26 Nov 1949 (adopted) vs 26 Jan 1950 (in force). Articles on citizenship, elections, provisional Parliament came into force on 26 Nov 1949 itself.

2-MINUTE REVISION

1773 Regulating → 1784 Pitt → 1833 Bentinck → 1858 Crown → 1909 separate electorates → 1919 dyarchy → 1935 federation → 1947 Independence Act → Constituent Assembly (9 Dec 1946; Prasad; Ambedkar drafts; 2y11m18d) → 26 Nov 1949 adopted → 26 Jan 1950 in force.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q. Who was the Constitutional Advisor? **B.N. Rau.** Q. Objectives Resolution moved by? **Nehru (13 Dec 1946).** Q. Dyarchy at provinces? **GoI Act 1919.** Q. Federal Court established under? **GoI Act 1935.**

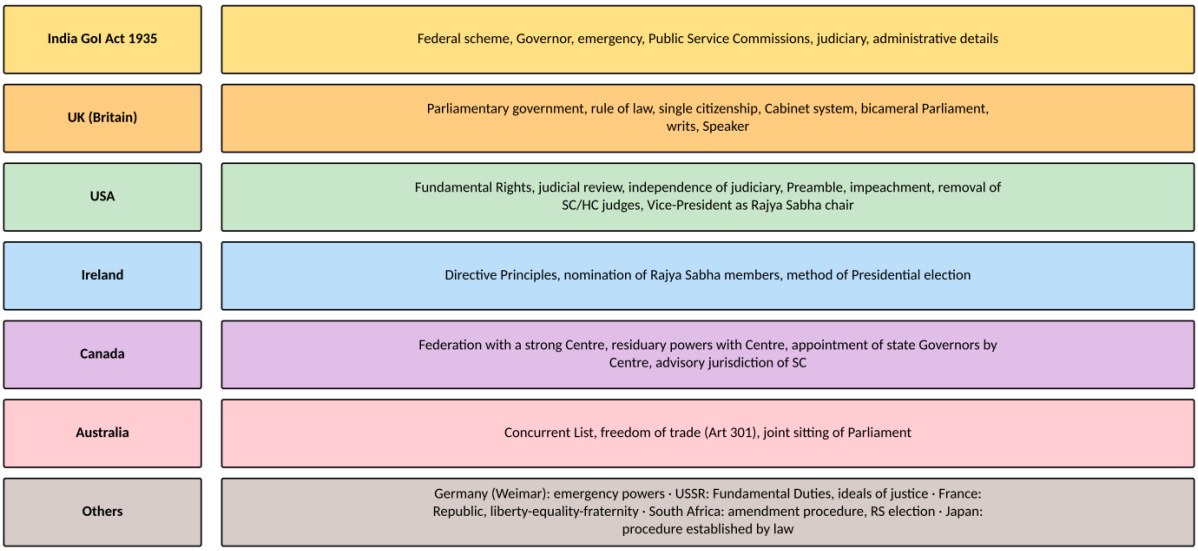
CHAPTER 2 — Sources and Salient Features of the Constitution

What is special about our Constitution

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Our Constitution is a **'bag of borrowings'**, but each borrowed idea was fitted to Indian needs. The **longest written constitution** of any sovereign country: it covers not only the structure of government but also administration, rights, and even local bodies. The picture shows which country gave which idea.

Where our Constitution borrowed from



Salient features: the 12-point list

Feature	What it means / where to find it
1. Lengthiest written	Original 395 Arts; Part XXI–XXII; reasons: GoI 1935 details, states in one document, diversity.
2. Partly rigid, partly flexible	Art 368; three kinds of amendment (chapter 8).
3. Federal with unitary bias	Ambedkar: 'Union of States', **indestructible Union, destructible states**. Strong Centre: single citizenship, emergency, All-India Services, Governor, Art 3, integrated judiciary.
4. Parliamentary form	Executive responsible to Legislature (Art 75, 164); collective responsibility.
5. Synthesis of parliamentary sovereignty and judicial supremacy	Judicial review (Art 13, 32, 226) with Parliament's power to amend.
6. Fundamental Rights (Part III)	Art 12–35; justiciable; USA model.
7. DPSP (Part IV)	Art 36–51; Ireland; 'Novel feature' (Ambedkar).
8. Fundamental Duties (Part IV-A)	Art 51A; 42nd Amdt; USSR.
9. Secular State	Positive secularism: equal respect to all religions (Art 25–28); word added 1976.
10. Universal adult franchise	Art 326; 21 → 18 by 61st Amdt (1988).
11. Independent judiciary, single integrated	Supreme Court at the top; High Courts; subordinate courts.
12. Emergency provisions, single citizenship, three-tier government	Art 352, 356, 360; 73rd and 74th Amdts add local bodies.

Is India federal or unitary? (Exam favourite)

Federal features	Unitary (Centre-biased) features
Written constitution, two levels of government, division of powers (7th Schedule)	Strong Centre: residuary powers, Art 3, Governor appointed by Centre
Supremacy of Constitution, independent judiciary, rigid in parts	Single citizenship, integrated judiciary, All-India Services, emergency, unitary election machinery (EC)

EXAM TRAPS

The word 'federation' is **not** in the Constitution: Art 1 says **'India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States'**. **K.C. Wheare:** 'quasi-federal'. **S.R. Bommai (1994):** federalism is basic structure.

Parliamentary system, Cabinet, Rule of law, writs, bicameralism = UK. Judicial review, FR, impeachment = USA. DPSP = Ireland. Concurrent List, Joint sitting = Australia. Residuary powers with Centre = Canada.